Christmas Dinner Countdown 2026

Christmas Day is Friday, December 25, 2026. Tick each step as you go.

Countdown

- [ ] **Fri Dec 4 - Three weeks out**
- [ ] **Fri Dec 11 - Two weeks out**
- [ ] **Fri Dec 18 - One week out**
- [ ] **Tue Dec 22 - Three days out**
- [ ] **Wed Dec 23 - Two days out**
- [ ] **Thu Dec 24 - Christmas Eve**
- [ ] **Fri Dec 25 - Christmas Day**
- [ ] **Sat Dec 26 - Boxing Day**

Turkey size (USDA: about 1 lb whole bird per person, 1.5 lb for leftovers)

6 guests: 6 lb (2.7 kg) with leftovers 9 lb (4.1 kg)
8 guests: 8 lb (3.6 kg) with leftovers 12 lb (5.4 kg)
10 guests: 10 lb (4.5 kg) with leftovers 15 lb (6.8 kg)
12 guests: 12 lb (5.4 kg) with leftovers 18 lb (8.2 kg)

Start fridge thawing a frozen turkey by (ready Christmas morning)

8 to 12 lb (3.6 to 5.4 kg): 3 days, start by Tue Dec 22
12 to 16 lb (5.4 to 7.3 kg): 4 days, start by Mon Dec 21
16 to 20 lb (7.3 to 9.1 kg): 5 days, start by Sun Dec 20
20 to 24 lb (9.1 to 10.9 kg): 6 days, start by Sat Dec 19

Our dinner time: _____ Guests: _____ Turkey ordered / picked up: _____

Notes

Planning sheet only: always follow your recipe and the turkey's label for thawing, cooking times and temperatures.
Free for personal use. Want the menu planner, shopping list by aisle, make-ahead plan, oven timeline, seating and leftovers pages?
See the Christmas Dinner Planner by Ledger and Leaf Printables on Etsy.